

Chapter Five

5. Understanding International Relations and Foreign policy

5.1. Meaning, Nature and Evolution of International Relations

A. What is International Relation?

- ✓ A term international relations first used by Jeremy Bentham in 1798.
- ✓ International relations literally refer to the interrelationships of states.
- ✓ The study of the **political and social interactions of state, non-state actors and individuals.**
- ✓ Today, international relations could be used to describe a range of interactions **between people, groups, firms, associations, parties, nations or states** or between these and (non) governmental international organizations.

- ✓ Participation in international relations or politics is also inescapable.
- ✓ There is **no state** in the world today that is completely **self-sufficient** or **isolated from others**. Each state is directly or indirectly dependent on the other.
- ✓ No **individual**, **people**, **nation** or **state** can exist in splendid isolation or be master of its own fate; but none, no matter how powerful in military, diplomatic or economic circles, even a giant superpower, can compel everyone to do its bidding.
- ✓ On the other hand, there are **legal, political and social differences** between domestic and international politics.
- ✓ Domestic law is generally obeyed, and if not, the police and courts enforce sanctions.
- ✓ International law rests on competing legal systems, and **there is no common enforcement**.

- ✓ Domestically a government has a **monopoly on the legitimate use of force**.
- ✓ In international politics no one has a monopoly of force, and therefore international politics has often been interpreted as the realm of self-help. There is accepted that some states are stronger than others.
- ✓ Domestic and international politics also differ in their underlying sense of **community** – in international politics, divided peoples do not share the same loyalties – **people disagree about what seems just and legitimate; order and justice**.

B. Nature and Evolution of International

- ✓ In medieval Europe there were **two institutions** with pretensions to power over the continent as a whole – the **(Catholic) Church** and the **Empire**.
- ✓ The Church was the spiritual authority, with its centre in Rome.
- ✓ The Empire – known as the **Holy Roman Empire** – was established in the 10th C in central, predominantly **German-speaking**, Europe.
- ✓ It also included parts of Italy, France and today's Netherlands and Belgium. It too derived legitimacy from the Roman Empire, but had none of its political power.
- ✓ Meanwhile, in Germany, the pope struggled with the emperor over the issue of **who of the two should have the right to appoint bishops**.

- While the two were fighting it out, the constituent members of the Holy Roman Empire took the opportunity to assert their independence.
- This was also when the kings of France and England began acting more independently, defying the pope's orders.
- In England, the king repealed the pope's right to levy taxes on the people. With the Reformation in the sixteenth century the notion of a unified Europe broke down completely as the Church began to split apart.
- Before long the followers of Martin Luther, 1483–1546, and John Calvin, 1509–1564, had formed their own religious denominations which did not take orders from Rome.
- Instead the new churches aligned themselves with the new states. Or rather, various kings, such as Henry VIII in England or Gustav Vasa in Sweden, took advantage of the religious strife in order to further their own political agendas.

- By supporting the Reformation, they could free themselves from the power of Rome.
- All over northern Europe, the new ‘Protestant’ churches became state-run and church lands became property of the state.
- These lead to 30 years religious war.
- From the sixteenth century onwards the states established the rudiments of an administrative system and raised armies, both in order to fight their own peasants and in order to defend themselves against other states. Since such state-building was expensive, the search for money became a constant concern.
- The Thirty Years’ War, **1618–1648**, was the bloodiest and most protracted military confrontation of the era.
- As a result of the war, Germany’s population was reduced by around a third.

- ✓ What the Swiss or the Scottish mercenaries did not steal, the Swedish troops destroyed. Many of the people who did not die on the battlefield died of the **plague**. The Thirty Years' War is often called a **religious conflict since Catholic states confronted Protestants**.
- ✓ Yet, Protestant and Catholic countries sometimes fought on the same side and religious dogma was clearly not the first thing on the minds of the combatants.
- ✓ Instead the war concerned which state should have hegemony (or dominance) over Europe. That is, which state, if any, would take over from the universal institutions of the Middle Ages.
- ✓ The main protagonists were two Catholic states, France and Austria, but Sweden – a Protestant country – intervened on France's side and in the end no dominant power emerged.

- ✓ The Treaty of Westphalia, 1648, which concluded the 30 years of warfare, has come to symbolize the new way of organizing international politics.
- ✓ From this point onwards, international politics was a matter of relations between states and no other political units.
- ✓ All states were **sovereign**, meaning that they laid claims to the exclusive right to rule their own territories and to act, in relation to other states, as they themselves saw fit.
- ✓ All states were formally **equal** and they had the same rights and obligations.
- ✓ Taken together, the states interacted with each other in a system in which there was no overarching power.
- Sovereignty and formal equality led to the problem of anarchy.
- It was only in the nineteenth century that relations between Europe and the rest of the world were irrevocably transformed.

- ✓ The reason is above all to be found in economic changes taking place in Europe itself.
- ✓ At the end of the eighteenth century, new ways of manufacturing goods were invented which made use of machines powered by steam, and later by electricity, which made it possible to engage in large-scale factory production. As a result of this so called 'industrial revolution', the Europeans could produce many more things and do it far more efficiently.
- ✓ As cheap, mass-produced goods flooded European markets, the Europeans began looking for new markets overseas.
- ✓ Towards the end of the nineteenth century, other European countries joined in this scramble for colonies, not least in Africa. Colonial possessions became a symbol of 'great power' status, and the new European nation-states often proved themselves to be very aggressive colonizers.

- ✓ Once they finally made themselves independent in the decades after the Second World War, as an international climate of decolonization took hold, all new states had a familiar form. They had their respective territories and fortified borders; their own capitals, armies, foreign ministries, flags, national anthems and all the other paraphernalia of European statehood.

5.2. Actors of International Relations: State and Non-State Actors

- The participants in international relations, often called *actors*, have a great influence on the relationships between nations and on world affairs.
- The major participants include:
 - ✓ *The state* (nations themselves, the leaders of those nations)
 - ✓ *Sub-state actors* (groups or organizations within a nation),
 - ✓ *Transnational actors* (organizations operating in more than one country), and international organizations.

A. The State Actors

- ✓ All states have their own capitals, armies, foreign ministries, flags and national anthems.
- ✓ International politics come to be defined in **terms of interactions between states in an international system** of states where these are *‘sovereign’ entities, territorially bound, and independent ultimately of any external authority.*
- ✓ Nations vary in size and power
- ✓ The **great powers** include the United States, Great Britain, Russia (formerly the Soviet Union), France, China, Germany, and Japan.
- ✓ These powers are the most important actors in international relations.
- ✓ **Leaders** (The most important individual actor within a nation is the top leader of that country, i.e. *The president/The Prime Minister*).

B. Non/Sub-State Actors

- ✓ Are groups and individuals within that nation that influence its international relationships. These *domestic actors*, include particular industries with distinct interests in foreign policy (such as the automobile or tobacco industry) and ethnic constituencies with ties to foreign countries, as well as labor unions, cities, and regions.
- ✓ These groups can influence a nation's foreign policy in several ways, such as by **lobbying political leaders, donating money to political candidates or parties, or swaying public opinion on certain issues.**

C. Transnational Actors

✓ Are Organizations/firms which are operating in more than one country.

✓ Transnational actors include

A. Multinational corporations

B. Nongovernmental organizations (NGOs),

C. Intergovernmental organizations (IGOs) like; EU

✓ They are usually created to promote cooperation between different nations on a particular issue or in a particular geographic region.

5.3. levels of Analysis in International Relation

A. *The individual level*

- International relations can be analyzed from the perspective of individuals. Here we would look at the behaviors, motivations, beliefs and orientation of the individual in affecting a particular international phenomenon.
- This can be seen in the psychology and emotions behind people's actions and decisions, their fears and their visions as well as their access to information and capacity to make a difference.

B. *The group level*

- ✓ A group-level analysis focusing on foreign policy would look at the role of lobbying groups, special interest groups and the way they influence national decision-making on an issue.

C. The state level

- ✓ Also known as '*state-centrism*'.
- ✓ In this level of analysis the state acts as the arena in which state officials, politicians and decision-makers operate.
- ✓ The state is seen as the framework that encapsulates society and as the main point of reference for the individual.
- ✓ A state-level study would also require careful consideration of what kinds of states we are looking at
 - ❑ *How they are ordered politically,*
 - ❑ *Their geographical position,*
 - ❑ *Their historical ties and experiences and their economic standing.*

D. The system level

- ✓ This level of analysis conceive the global system as the structure or context within which states cooperate, compete and confront each other over issues of national interest.
- ✓ It is a level above the state.
- ✓ It is usually distributed into three main types of systems i.e.
 - i. *Uni-polar system*
 - ii. *Bipolar system and*
 - iii. *Multipolar system.*
- ✓ In a *uni-polar international system* there is one state with the greatest political, economic, cultural and military power and hence the ability to totally control other states.

- ✓ In the case of the **bipolar system**, there are two dominant states (super powers) and the less powerful states join either sides through alliance and counter alliance formations. (*E.g.. Cold war period*).
- ✓ The problem with bipolar system is that it is vulnerable for **zero-sum game politics** because when one superpower gains the other would inevitably lose.
- **Multipolar system** usually reflects various equally powerful states competing for power.
- ✓ In such system, it is possible to bring change without gaining or losing power.

Power, Anarchy and Sovereignty in the International System

Power

- ✓ Power is the *currency* of international politics. As money is for economics, power is for international relations (politics).
- ✓ In the international system, power determines the relative influence of actors and it shapes the structure of the international system.
- ✓ Power can also be defined as *‘A’ s’ ability to get ‘B’*.

Anarchy

- ✓ Anarchy is a situation where there is absence of authority (government) be it in national or international/global level systems.

✓ Within a country ‘anarchy’ refers to a breakdown of law and order, but in relations between states it refers to a system where power is decentralized and there are no shared institutions with the right to enforce common rules.

✓ An anarchical world is a world where everyone looks after themselves and no one looks after the system as a whole.

Sovereignty

✓ Sovereignty is another basic concept in international relations and it can be defined as an expression of:

i. A state’s ultimate authority within its territorial entity (*internal sovereignty*) and,

ii. The state’s involvement in the international community (*external sovereignty*).

✓ In short, sovereignty denotes double claim of states from the international system, i.e., autonomy in foreign policy and independence/freedom in its domestic affairs.

5.4. Contending Theories of international Relations

- ✓ Theories of international relations allow us to understand and try to make sense of the world around us through various lenses, each of which represents a different theoretical perspective.
- ✓ Here it introduces the *traditional theories, middle-ground theories and critical theories* of international relations.

- ✓ The formative assumptions of realism as a school of thought center on the view that the international system is ‘anarchic’, in the sense that it is devoid of an all-encompassing authority.
- ✓ Realists believe that nations act only out of *self-interest* and that their major goal is to advance their own positions of power in the world
- ✓ Conflict is hence an *inevitable* and continual feature of international relations.
- ✓ *Necessity, not freedom*, is the appropriate or realistic starting-point for understanding international relations.
- ✓ Realists are great lovers of *history* and Accordingly history teaches us that war and conflict are the norm in international relations.

5.4.1. Realism and Neo-Realism

- ✓ The ideas of realism come from the writings of such historical figures as *Sun Tzu of ancient China, Thucydides of ancient Greece, Italy's Niccolò Machiavelli. Thomas Hobbes, and Max Weber.*
- ✓ Realists argue that values are context bound, that morality is determined by interest, and that the conditions of the present are determined by historical processes.
- ✓ They claimed that there was no natural harmony of interests among states and that it was foolish and even dangerous to hope that the struggle for power among states could be tamed by *international law, democratization, and international commerce.*
- ✓ The formative assumptions of realism as a school of thought center on the view that the international system is 'anarchic', in the sense that it is devoid of an all-encompassing authority.

- ✓ Realists believe that nations act only out of *self-interest* and that their major goal is to advance their own positions of power in the world
- ✓ Conflict is hence an *inevitable* and continual feature of international relations.
- ✓ *Necessity, not freedom*, is the appropriate or realistic starting-point for understanding international relations.
- ✓ Realists are great lovers of *history* and Accordingly history teaches us that war and conflict are the norm in international relations.
- ✓ Realism gained momentum during the *Second World War* when it appeared to offer a convincing account for how and why the worst conflict in known history originated after a period of supposed peace and optimism.

- ✓ They argued that the leaders of nations use their power to advance the interests of their own nations with *little regard for morality or friendship*.
- ✓ Realists believe nations should always be heavily *armed and ready for war*. Hence, Friendships, religions, ideologies, cultures, and economic systems matter little.
- ✓ Hobbes described human beings as living in an order-less ‘state of nature’ that he perceived as *‘a war of all against all’*.

5.4.2. Idealism

- ✓ Sometimes referred to as *utopianism* and it is a variant of *liberal internationalism*.
- ✓ Its proponents (*Immanuel Kant, Richard Cobden, John Hobson, Norman Angell, Alfred Zimmern, and Woodrow Wilson*) view human beings as innately good and believe peace and harmony between nations is not only achievable, but desirable.
- ✓ They believe *international law* (principles and rules of conduct that nations regard as binding) and *morality* are key influences on international events, rather than power alone.
- ✓ Idealists think that human nature is basically good. Hence.
- ✓ They believe *good habits* (such as telling the truth in diplomatic dealings with other nations), education, and the existence of international organizations such as the UN to facilitate good relations between nations will result in peaceful and cooperative international relationships.

❖ *A central characteristic of idealism/Liberalism are:*

- ✓ They believe in the belief that what unites human beings is more important than what divides them.
- ✓ They are naive about the world around them.
- ✓ They are futurists who seek a perfect world.
- ✓ They focus on the interdependence of the world's countries and the mutual benefits they can gain through cooperating with each other.
- ✓ They placed so much importance on International organizations like, the League of Nations and on strengthening international law.
- ✓ They have faith in the idea that the permanent cessation of war is an attainable goal

- ✓ Idealism came to prominence in reaction to the carnage of the *First World War* and In the early years, from *1919 to the 1930s*, the discipline was dominated by what is conventionally referred to as liberal internationalism.
- ✓ Idealists/Liberals also argue that international law offers a mechanism by which cooperation among states is made possible and in playing this role, international law performs two different functions. i.e.
 - A. Operating system* (provide mechanisms for cross-border interactions)
 - B. Normative system* (shape the values and goals these interactions are pursuing).

❖ The nexus between Realism and Idealism

- A. One central area that sets realism and liberalism apart is how they view human nature because, realists do not typically believe that human beings are inherently good, or have the potential for good, as liberals do.
- B. Realists and liberals look at the very same world.
 - When viewing that world through the *realist lens*, the world appears to be one of domination. The realist lens magnifies instances of *war and conflict* and then uses those to paint a certain picture of the world.
 - *Idealists/Liberals*, when looking at the same world, adjust their lenses to blur out areas of domination and instead bring areas of *cooperation* into focus. Then, they can paint a slightly different picture of the same world.

- C. Liberals share an *optimistic view* of IR, believing that world order can be improved, with peace and progress gradually replacing war. Conversely, realists tend to dismiss optimism as a form of misplaced idealism and instead they arrive at a more *pessimistic view*.
- D. In terms of liberalism, its proponents argue that organizations are valuable in assisting states in formulating decisions and helping to formalize cooperation that leads to peaceful outcomes, but Realists on the other hand believe states partake in international organizations only when it is in their self-interest to do so.

Summary

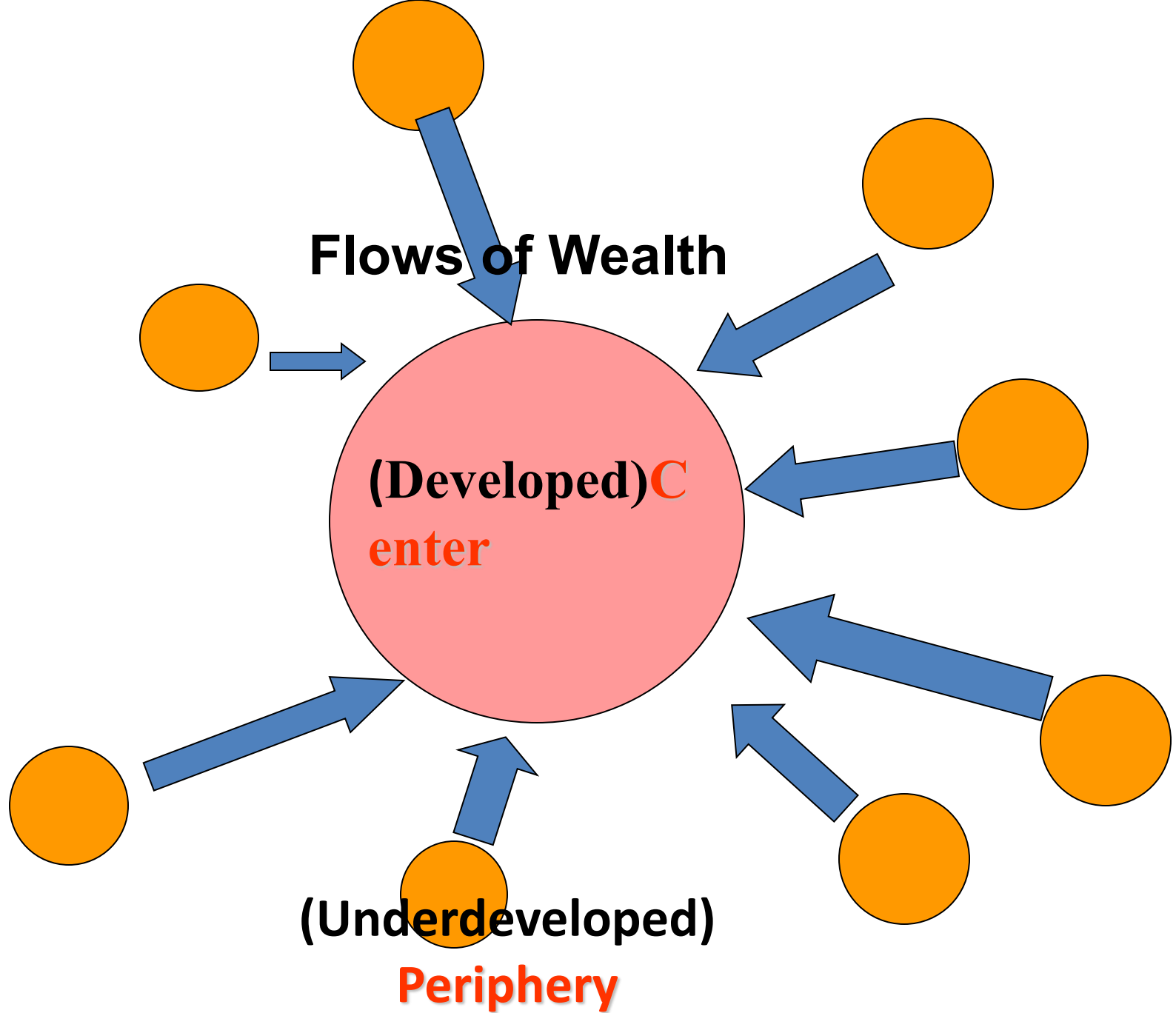
	Realism	Idealism
What do nations want?	Power	Peace in the world according to the principles defined by nations.
What motivates the nation in IR	Self-interest	Values and principles
What are the source of conflict in the world	Competing for the interest(i.e. territory and resource)	Competing “-isim” (e.g. Democracy Vs. monarchy, totalitarianism or communism)
What is the source of security in IR	Faith in power to protect the nation.	Faith in law or morality to protect the nation
What kind of security the nation are seeking	National security	Global security
Willingness to use power	Limited to interest at the time skeptical of national ability to transcend self-interest	Omnipotent, unlimited faith in ability of national control and thousands common interest in universal goal.

5.4.3. Marxism/Structuralism

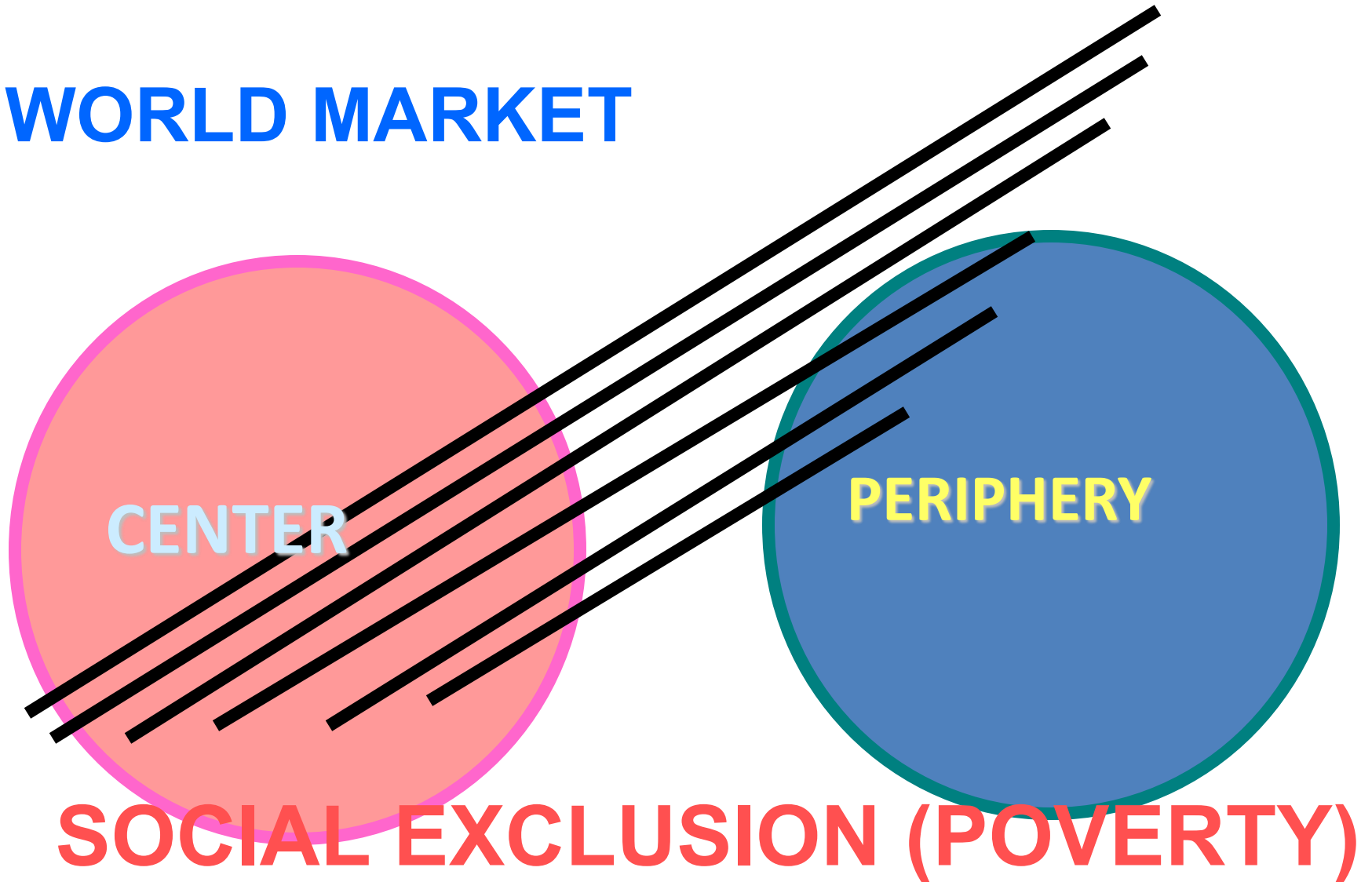
❖ Proletariat Vs. Bourgeoisie

- ✓ This third perspective or paradigm emerged as a critique of both realism and pluralism concentrated on the *inequalities* that exist within the international system, inequalities of wealth between the rich **‘North/West’** or the **‘First World’** and the poor **‘South’** or the **‘Third World’**.
- ✓ Marxism is an ideology that argues that a capitalist society is divided into two contradictory classes i.e.
 - A. The business class (the bourgeoisie) and*
 - B. The working class (the proletariat).*
- They focus on ***dependency, exploitation and the international division of labor*** which relegated the vast majority of the global population to the extremes of poverty

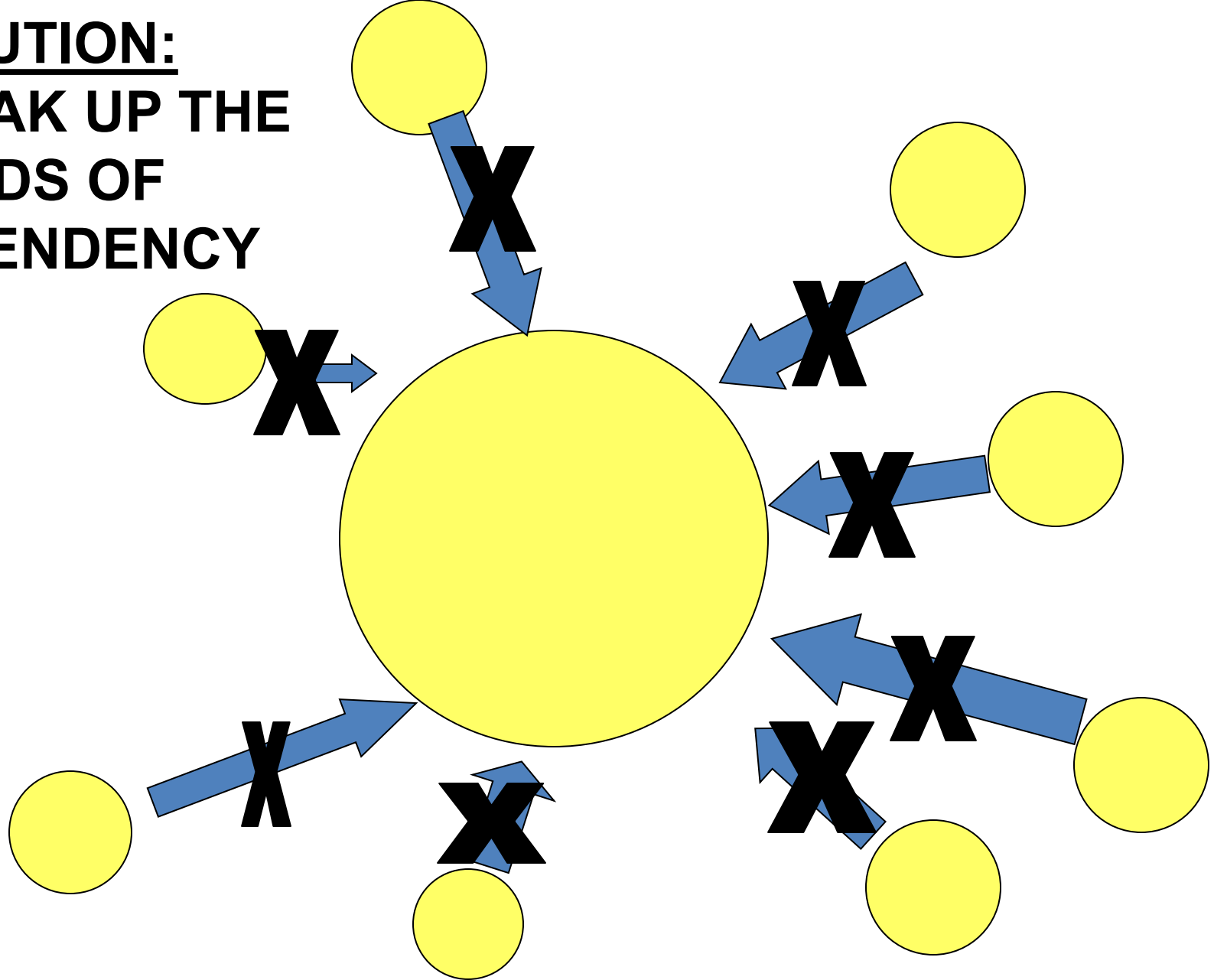
- ✓ Accordingly the *class system* that pre-dominated internally within capitalist societies had its parallel globally, producing *Centre-periphery* relations that permeated every aspect of international social, economic and political life.
- ✓ Thus, where pluralism and its liberal associations had viewed networks of economic interdependence as a basis of increasing international cooperation founded on trade and financial interactions, neo-Marxist structuralism viewed these processes as the basis of *inequality, the debt burden, violence and instability.*



WORLD MARKET



SOLUTION:
BREAK UP THE
BONDS OF
DEPENDENCY



5.4.4. Critical theory

- ✓ The leading scholars of this theory are *Jurgen Habermas*, *Robert Cox* and *Andrew Linklater*.
- ✓ Critical theory refers to a set of *Marxist-inspired* critical analyses of international theory and practice.
- ✓ Critical theorists share one particular trait in a sense that they oppose commonly held assumptions in the field of IR that have been central since its establishment.
- ✓ They altered circumstances call for new approaches that are better suited to understand, as well as question, *the world we find ourselves in*.
- ✓ *Jurgen Habermas*, emphasizes on the intimate connection between knowledge and interests.

- ✓ Accordingly, concept of truth is established by *rational consensus*. What is true is what is agreed to be true, but this consensus must have specific rational features, otherwise truth loses all meaning.
- ✓ For *Andrew Linklater*, another leading critical theorist in the field, questions of *inclusion and exclusion* are central to international relations.
- ✓ He advocates a *community of humankind* and he wants to construct new forms of inter-national political relations that are able to include *all people on equal grounds*.
- ✓ Finally, Critical theorists also provide a voice to individuals who have frequently been *marginalized*, particularly women and those from the Global South.

5.4.5. Constructivism

- ✓ Constructivism is another theory commonly viewed as a *middle ground*
- ✓ Constructivism is a distinctive approach to international relations that focuses on the *social interaction of agents or actors in world politics*
- ✓ They highlight the importance of values and shared interests between individuals who interact on the global stage.
- ✓ *Alexander Wendt*, a prominent constructivist, described the relationship between agents (individuals) and structures (such as the state) as one in which structures not only *constrain* agents but also *construct* their identities and interests.
- ✓ The core of constructivism, is that the essence of international relations exists in the interactions between people.
- ✓ After all, states do not interact; it is agents of those states, such as *politicians and diplomats*, who interact.

- ✓ Constructivists insist that international relations cannot be reduced to rational action and interaction within material constraints (as some *realists claim*) or within institutional constraints at the international and national levels (as argued by some *liberal internationalists*).
- ✓ For constructivists, state interaction is not among *fixed national interests*, but must be understood as a pattern of action that shapes and is shaped by identities over time.
- ✓ According to constructivists, international institutions have both *regulative* and *constitutive* functions.
- ✓ *Regulative norms* set basic rules for standards of conduct by prescribing or proscribing certain behaviors.
- ✓ *Constitutive norms* define a behavior and assign meanings to that behavior.

❖ Constructivists accept that *anarchy* is the characteristic condition of the international system, but argue that, by itself, it mean nothing.

* For example, an anarchy of friends is quite different from an anarchy of enemies, but both are possible.

✓ *As a theoretical approach, constructivism is difficult to employ.*

Constructivism, for example, does not predict any particular social structure to govern the behavior of states. Rather, it requires that a given social relationship be examined, articulated and, ultimately understood.

5.4.6. Modernism and post-Modernism

- Modernization scholars believed that the transition to modernity, the condition of being modern, would recapitulate the European experience.
- ✓ **Modernity:** typically denotes "a post-traditional, post-medieval historical period", in particular, one marked by progress from *agrarianism* via the rise of *industrialism, capitalism, secularization, the nation-state*, and its constituent forms of surveillance.
- ✓ Hence, to be modernized you need to “*change in a value and attitude*”
- ✓ According to this theory, development in developing countries would come about and would be engineered through the diffusion of *innovations, capital, technology, modern ideas, entrepreneurial ship, democratic institutions, and values* from the developed western societies.

❖ **Post Modernism** literally means '*after the modernist movement*'

✓ *It* is a distinctive approach to the study of international relations that emerged in the 1980s.

❖ It is characterized by three main themes.

1. First, postmodernists are hostile towards claims to universal or absolute truth.

✓ They argue that all truth-claims are based on met narratives, or background worldviews, according to which particular claims to truth or value are legitimated or rejected.

2. Second, postmodernists seek to unmask putatively emancipatory grand narratives as oppressive.

Particular liberations have given birth to new forms of ‘caging’. *Liberalism* has emancipated us from *feudalism* only to deliver us to *capitalism*. *Marxism* has merely replaced *capitalism* with *Stalinism*. Modern science has neglected and marginalized pre modern forms of human knowledge.

3. The third theme calls for ‘respect for difference’.

7. Feminism

- **Feminism is theory that men and women should be equal politically, economically and socially.**
- They look at the origins, characteristics, and forms of gender inequality in order to focus on
 - *gender politics,*
 - *power relations, and*
 - *sexuality.*
- Its politics centers on immediate issues like reproductive rights, domestic violence, maternity leave, equal pay, sexual harassment, discrimination, and sexual violence.....and finally looking for solutions.

5.6. National Interest, Foreign Policy and Diplomacy of Ethiopia: pas and Present

❖ National Interest

- ✓ Of all the concepts , this one is the most vague and therefore easily used and abused, particularly by politicians.
- ✓ The word *interest* implies a need that has, by some standard of justification, attained the status of an acceptable claim on behalf of the state. On the other hand, the *national interest* is also used to describe and support particular policies.
- ✓ In formal terms, one can identify two attributes of such policies.
- ✓ The first is one of *inclusiveness*(the policies should concern the country as a whole, or at least a sufficiently substantial subset of its membership to transcend the specific interests of particular groups).

- ✓ In contrast, the second attribute is one of *exclusiveness* (The national interest does not necessarily include the interests of groups outside the state, although it may do so).
- ✓ National interest is the *raison de`tat*, (the reason of state), to justify its actions and policy towards other states at international level.
- ✓ It is a set of values, orientation, goals and objectives a given country would like to achieve in its international relations.
- ✓ It has been the main driving force that determines the contents of foreign policy.
- ✓ However, there are controversies on the exact meaning, scope and contents of national interests.

❖ **A. K. Holsti**, defines national interest as “an image of the future state of affairs and future set of conditions that governments through individual policy makers aspire to bring about by wielding influence abroad and by changing or sustaining the behaviors of other states”. (*NI=Ambition*)

❖ **Seabury**, defines national interest as “...set of purposes which a nation should seek to realize in the conduct of its foreign relations” or “ it is those purposes which the nation/state through its leadership appears to pursue persistently over time”.

- ❖ National interest can also be defined as the sum of the goals and objectives of a state's foreign policy.
- ❖ However, there is a major division of opinion regarding whether national interest can be defined *objectively* or *subjectively*.
- ❖ For *Plato*, the good of the polis (that is the public good) could best be arrived at by philosopher king aided by a few highly learned, detached and fair-minded advisors.
- ❑ Even if the national interests of states vary in that detail, core national interests are the same for different courtiers and the minimum essential components of the national interest of any state are
 - *security*,
 - *national development* and
 - *world order*.

- ❖ National interest is a key concept in foreign policy and the making of foreign policy begins by identifying the state's key national interests.

❑ *Overview of Foreign Policy of Ethiopia*

1. Foreign Policy during Tewodros II (1855-1868)

- Although the Ethiopian state traces its history back to more than 3000 years, the modern imperial state did not begin to emerge until the middle of 19th century.
- Throughout his reign ***Tewodros*** tried to develop a dynamic foreign policy that reached out beyond the Horn Region.
- The emperor attempted to establish his diplomatic relations to fight his immediate enemies claiming ***Christianity*** as instrument of foreign policy.

- As Keller has put it “he appealed specifically to *Britain, France and Russia* as Christian nations to assist him in whatever ways possible in his fight against the *Turks, Egyptians and Islam*”.
- The emperor attempted to establish his diplomatic relations to fight his immediate enemies claiming *Christianity* as instrument of foreign policy.

2. Foreign Policy during Yohannes IV (1872-1889)

- ✓ Like his predecessor, Yohannes considered Islam as a threat to the territorial integrity of the polity.
- ✓ Indeed Egypt tried to put a serious security threat having its motive was to control the source of *Blue Nile*.
- ✓ However, were not successful as Egypt faced subsequent defeat both in 1875 and 1876 at the *Battle of Gundet and Gura* respectively.
- ✓ In addition to Muslim threat, the emperor saw European expansionism as greater threat to the survival of the country which has turned out to be real as **Italy** got a foot hold at the port of **Massawa in 1885**.
- However, the emperor died fighting with the “*Mahadists*”. The Sudanese resistance groups against British rule happened to invade Western Ethiopia because of their presumption that Yohannes IV was collaborating with the British.

3. Foreign Policy during Menelik II (1889-93)

- ✓ Menelik was the *King of Shoa* region before his coronation as the Kings of Kings of Ethiopia.
- ✓ Before the death of Yohannes Italy had good diplomatic relation with Menelik with the objective of weakening its immediate enemy in the North, Yohannes.
- ✓ Menilik comfortably exploited the opportunity to consolidate his power, perhaps to deter Yohannes and bolster its expansionist policy to the south which had disappointed Yohannes as witnessed by the absence of Menelik from participation in the war against Mahadists.
- ✓ Following the death of Yohannes, however, Italy continued to be the main challenge in the North other colonial powers surrounding all four corners of the country as the scramble of Africa was heightened. (*Hold of Bogess, later named Eritrea, and Missawa*).

❑ The emperor followed double track diplomacy to contain or reverse Italy's expansion and maintain the territorial integrity of his country.

- 1) On the one hand, he entered many treaties and agreements to solve the challenge amicably. (***The 'Wuchalle' treaty***).
- 2) On the other hand the emperor was preparing himself by accumulating military ammunitions to defend the aggression from any side of colonial powers, British, French and of course Italy.

❑ However, the emperor's diplomatic endeavor with Italy failed to result in peace due to Italy's misinterpretation of the controversial article 17 of the '*Wuchalle*' treaty.

❑ In 1896, the emperor declared nation-wide war against Italy in defense of the territorial integrity and sovereignty of the century old nation.

4. Foreign Policy during Emperor Haile Selassie I (1916-1974)

- Menelik died in 1913 and it was not until 1930 that the next strong emperor Haile Selassie I, assumed the throne.
- He was dedicated to the creation of a stronger, centralized and bureaucratic empire with unquestioned respect by the international community.
- In 1923, when as Regent to the Crown, Teferi Mekonen, facilitated Ethiopia's entry to the *League of Nations*.
- When the Italian Fascists finally invade Ethiopia between 1936 and 1941, the Emperor fled to London and established a government in exile.
- In the immediate post-war period, Ethiopia was extremely dependent on British military, economic and technical aid.
- British Military Aid was withdrawn in 1952, and the King moved quickly to firm up relations with the United States.

- Ethiopia also played significant role in Africa in fighting for *African independence* and to end *colonialism and apartheid*.
- In this manner, the emperor can be considered as one of the founding fathers of African Unification.
- The emperor's strategic alliance with outside powers helped him to stay on power for decades.
- The emperor secured the territorial integrity of the country and also secured port through Eritrea, yet the abrogation of the UN imposed federation arrangement of Eritrea remained one of a foreign policy challenge to the military regime who came to power through coup de'tat.

5. Foreign Policy during the Military Government (1974—1991)

- The military regime that took control of state power in 1974 adopted a foreign policy largely oriented to *socialist ideology*.
- Since socialism was the guiding philosophy of the country, friendship and alliance with socialist countries of the world was considered as a viable strategy for realizing socialism at home and perhaps in the world.
- In this regard, the country was heavily dependent on military aid on the *Soviet Union* which prevented it from securing any kind of military and technical assistance from the US and other European countries.
- Internally Eritrean Liberation Front (ELF) launched military attack on the Ethiopian Army.
- Many external actors were involved in sponsoring the rebel group, including; *Saudi Arabia, Egypt, Sudan, Somalia and*

- Apart from the Dergue's near total dependence on the leaders in *Moscow* and their *Warsaw Pact allies* for military and logistical support during the war with Somalia and in the Eritrean conflict, several other factors have facilitated the consolidation of this new special relationship.
- Apart from socialism, Ethiopia's strategic locations and other questions, such as; *Eritrea, Somalia, and the issue of the Nile*, had also shaped the foreign policy orientation and behavior of military government. Ethiopia being located in the Horn of Africa is at the cross roads to the oil rich middle East region and Indian Ocean.
- In general the adoption of socialism and its subsequent impact on the foreign policy of the country could be considered as a departure from its predecessors; however the policy objective of the country remained unchanged.

6. The Foreign Policy of Ethiopia in the Post 1991

- With EPRDF's ascent to power the country adopted a new foreign policy orientation and objectives.
- In the post 1991 period, Ethiopia's foreign policy is driven primarily by the quest to ensure national interest and security.
- As such, one of the goals of the foreign policy is to ensure the survival of the *multi-national state*.
- The primary strategy in realization of these goals is to put the focus on domestic issues like addressing domestic political and economic problems requires forging national consensus about the problems and exit strategies from the problem.
- At diplomatic level, *economic diplomacy* is adopted to strengthen the domestic efforts in fighting poverty and backwardness and address the issues of development.

- Economic diplomacy involves *attracting foreign investments, seeking markets for Ethiopian exportable commodities, seeking aid and concessional loans* too.
- Ethiopia appreciates the East Asian countries economic successes and development paths and the country would like to learn from such successful countries such as *Singapore, Malaysian and Indonesia*.
- The other foreign policy strategy is building up the military capability of the country. Peaceful dialogues and negotiations will be employed to peacefully coexist with others.
- To this end the three regimes used a combination of both military force and diplomacy to address both internal and external challenges depending on the circumstances.
- In this manner, while the imperial and the military regime's foreign policy strategy is largely an approach the current regime followed *“in-side out”* approach.

The End of Chapter Five!